

Malden Hill Dec 5. 61
My Dear Sister Helen

Yours of the 2nd

I received yesterday & am so
I was glad enough to receive
it - It gives me the only real comfort
I have - to receive letters of news of
the the happiness & good health of my
children - & of my dear friends -

We are still encamped on Malden
Hill - May receive him at
winter - but I think we shall
be ordered forward before long
Nothing keeps us at this point now
but the sickness of the men - the
home had as high as 332 sick or one

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time but the number of
 men down to 248 - the
 Medical Director of Louisville
 has just issued an order requiring
 our men to be sent to the General
 Hospital at Louisville, which
 looks a little as though we were to
 be sent forward with the well
 ones - to engage in a fight which
 I think will take place within
 the next 20 days - it will be
 a decisive battle for the winter
 if we are victorious our army
 will move into Nashville
 and winter there - if we

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I am very sorry to hear you
are not well & I am afraid
you will get sick - if it is too
much for you & take care of the
baby & do your work - hire a
girl & do your work for you &
I will pay her - I enclose you
ten dollars which you will use
as you see fit - Did Kitty get \$10 -
or not? Did the girls get \$10. I sent them
this money I had from Uncle Sam - the
soldiers receive this in lieu of gold - & I suppose
it is just as good & more convenient to
carry - Keep my beautiful baby for me
& keep her right sweet - Keep Kitty & keep her
too - tell Kitty she must visit her little sister
often - Oh how much I would give to see Maggie
& how her & Kitty's pictures to her & send them
by mail in our next close - or without any close at all
Affectionately Yours
John

are repulsed, the most of
our forces will return to
this point & winter here
— So I think I have not
time to write you fully of our
condition here & of camp &
camp life but hope before long
to be able to do so — Our need
for government building logs
Cabin for winter houses which
we shall occupy if we don't
go forward — if we do someone
else will occupy them in our
place — We have had winter
another here for a few days past
there is snow on the ground
now but it melts away rather fast